



Black felt hat

Wide lapels

Silk tie

Bright, double-breasted jacket

Two-tone spectator shoes

West Indian style The zoot suit spread from the US to the Caribbean, where the local men interpreted it in brightly coloured cloth. West Indian migrants to Britain in the 1950s brought the style with them. This modern re-creation recalls the snappy fashion of that time.



Braces hold trousers just under ribs

Satin handkerchief

Two-tone shoes

Clown-like trousers pegged at ankles



Floppy silk cravat

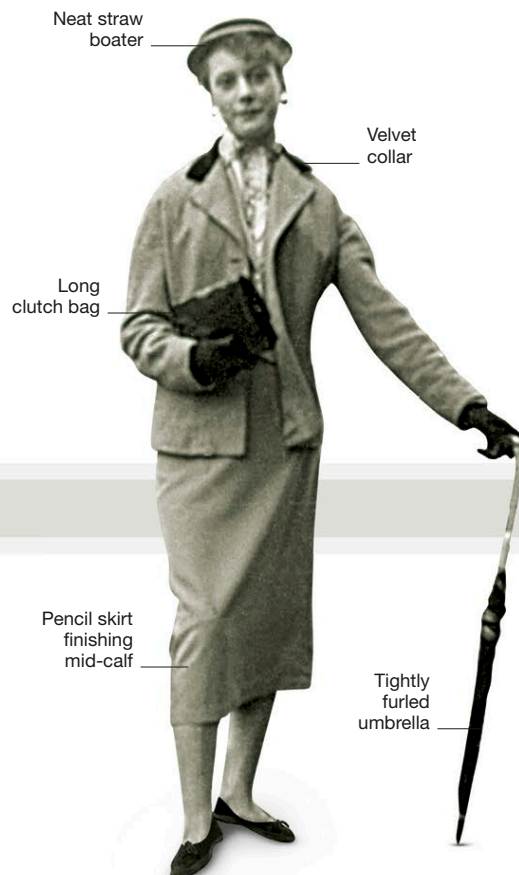
Crisp, white dress shirt

Wide lapels

Jacket reaches to tips of extended fingers

High-shine shoes

Fingertip jacket The drape was a more conservative version of the zoot suit. It had a shorter jacket, as in this 1994 reproduction by Chris Ruocco Tailors, London. Braces or a thin leather belt held the trousers high on the waist.



Neat straw boater

Velvet collar

Long clutch bag

Pencil skirt finishing mid-calf

Tightly furled umbrella

Accessorized This teddy girl wears a jacket borrowed from the teddy boys with its loose shape and velvet collar. She carries the signature teddy girl accessories of a clutch bag and an umbrella.

SHOES



Two-tone leather shoes



Crêpe-soled brothel creepers

Hipsters wore spiffy, thick-soled shoes that were often shiny, made of exotic skins, or two-tone, harking back to the jaunty, off-duty style worn by the wealthy man of leisure in the 1920s. Pointed shoes, historically a sign of status, were also popular. Shoes were worn to attract attention, never to blend with the suit. Teddy boys adopted chunky, crêpe-soled, suede “brothel creepers” to ground their look. Alternatively, they sported smart leather Derbys with thick soles.

Exaggerated shape This sharp zoot suit is inspired by the exuberant jazz singer Cab Calloway in the 1943 film *Stormy Weather*. Political activist Malcolm X once described this look as “a killer-diller coat with a drape shape, reat-pleats, and shoulders padded like a lunatic’s cell”.